Marxism's rhetorical commitment to internationalism and worldwide revolution took a variety of forms in Latin America in the twentieth century. During the Popular Front period Communist parties worldwide followed Stalin's lead in allying with what they called "bourgeois political parties" and participating in electoral politics. This meant that many Latin American Marxists opposed armed revolution. While Latin American revolutionaries frequently drew on some aspects of Marxism, they also turned for inspiration to other Latin American traditions, and to national liberation and social justice movements in their own countries' pasts. Latin American history offered a broad spectrum of revolutionary thinkers and movements, ranging from indigenous and slave uprisings against the Spanish to their wars of independence to twentieth-century labor and popular struggles. Latin American revolutionaries developed their own forms of internationalism.

Che Guevara, for example, attributed his revolutionary consciousness to the poverty and exploitation he had seen in his travels through Latin America. In Guatemala in 1954, he witnessed the first U.S. Cold War intervention, when U.S.-trained and backed counter-revolutionary forces overthrew the democratically elected government of Jacobo Arbenz. Anti-Batista publications in Havana identified with the anti-colonial struggle against the French in Algeria in the 1950s. "Since it was not always possible to attack Batista's regime directly, they covered instead the revolutionary struggle in Algeria," one Cuban observer explained.[16]

Cuba and Black Internationalism

Cubans were not the only people to draw a connection between colonial oppression in Africa and in Latin America and the Caribbean. Black Martinican revolutionary psychiatrist and author Frantz Fanon developed his analysis of colonial oppression while working in Algeria and writing about the Algerian Revolution in the 1950s. Black internationalism – also sometimes called African nationalism – that saw black oppression as part of a global colonial phenomenon and asked blacks worldwide to identify with a common struggle against it, had roots in earlier periods – especially the Garveyite movement of the